

1560

First scientific society

Giambattista della Porta was an Italian playwright and polymath (someone who knows a lot about many subjects). He founded what is believed to be the world's first scientific society in Naples, Italy. Membership of the society, called the *Academia Secretorum Naturae* (Academy of the Mysteries of Nature) was open to anyone who had made a new scientific discovery.

1561

Anatomical discovery

Gabriello Falloppio, an Italian anatomist and professor of surgery at Padua University, in Italy, published a description of the human reproductive organs. He gave his name to the Fallopian tubes, the pair of channels in female mammals through which eggs pass from the ovaries to the uterus.



Ambroise Paré operates on a patient in this 19th-century print

1564

Compassionate surgery

French surgeon Ambroise Paré wrote a manual of modern surgery based on his experience of carrying out amputations on the battlefield. Ahead of his time, Paré stated that pain relief, healing, and good patient care were essential to successful surgery.

1560

1565

1570

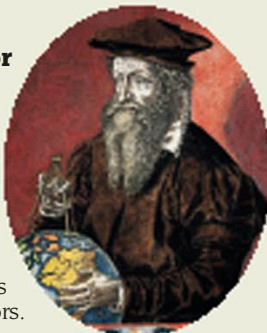
1550–1570

MAPMAKING SKILLS

Advances in navigation and exploration in the 1500s led to improvements in mapmaking. The center of mapmaking was Antwerp (in modern-day Belgium), then a busy center of international trade. Printed collections of maps familiarized Europeans with the new lands discovered in America and Asia.

Gerard Mercator

In 1569, Flemish mapmaker Gerard Mercator published a new world map. His representation, or projection, of the globe on a flat surface used a grid of straight lines to show direction. This proved an aid to sailors.



The first atlas

Abraham Ortelius, a Flemish cartographer, published the first modern world atlas in 1570. It contained 70 separate maps on 53 sheets, showing all the countries and continents known at that time.